

Five Government Schemes *for Your Business*

Loans without collateral, subsidy you never pay back, and money for tech startups.

After the video on these schemes went up, the same question kept coming in the comments: "Bro, which one is for me, and where do I apply?" Fair question. I didn't know half of this myself till I sat with the actual scheme guidelines and the latest government numbers. So here it is in one place. What each scheme gives, who can apply, what the rules say, and the exact portal to go to.

I checked every figure against official sources in October 2026. Two of the five have had updates this year, and I've marked them clearly so you don't walk into a bank with old information.

- 1 PM Mudra Yojana.** Business loans from ₹50,000 up to ₹20 lakh with no collateral. For almost any small business.
- 2 Stand-Up India.** ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore for SC, ST and women entrepreneurs starting something new. A bigger version is on the way.
- 3 PMEGP.** Start a new unit and the government pays 15% to 35% of the project cost. You don't repay that part.
- 4 SAMRIDH.** Up to ₹40 lakh for early-stage tech product startups, through a selected accelerator.
- 5 PM Vishwakarma.** For 18 traditional trades. Free training with pay, a ₹15,000 toolkit and loans at 5% interest.

MUDRA LOAN

up to ₹20L

PMEGP SUBSIDY

15% to 35%

SAMRIDH SUPPORT

up to ₹40L

VISHWAKARMA LOAN

5% interest

Five schemes, *side by side*

If you only read one page, read this one. The rest of the guide goes scheme by scheme.

SCHEME	WHAT YOU GET	WHO IT'S FOR	STATUS (OCT 2026)
PM Mudra Yojana	Collateral-free loan, ₹50,000 to ₹20 lakh	Any non-farm small business: shop, service, manufacturing, trading, allied agri work	Open. Apply at any bank, NBFC or MFI
Stand-Up India	Bank loan, ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore	SC, ST and women entrepreneurs, new (greenfield) ventures	Being relaunched with bigger benefits. Details awaited
PMEGP	Bank loan plus 15% to 35% subsidy on project cost (up to ₹50L / ₹20L)	Anyone 18+ starting a new unit	Open. Subsidy given out as recently as Sept 2026
SAMRIDH	Up to ₹40 lakh, matched by an accelerator, plus mentoring	Early-stage tech and software product startups	Running through MeitY-selected accelerators
PM Vishwakarma	Training with ₹500/day stipend, ₹15,000 toolkit, ₹3 lakh loan at 5%	Artisans in 18 traditional trades	Running till FY 2027-28. 30 lakh registration target reached

Status as checked on 7 October 2026 against Finance Ministry, KVIC, MeitY and MSME sources. Full list on the last page.

1 A quick way to find yours

IF YOU ARE...	START WITH	WHY
Running a shop, salon, tailoring unit, food stall, small workshop and need money to grow	Mudra	Fastest route. No collateral, small tickets, every bank does it
Starting a brand new manufacturing or service unit	PMEGP	The subsidy brings down what you actually repay
A woman, SC or ST founder planning a bigger new venture (₹10L+)	Stand-Up India	Higher loan size. Keep an eye on the relaunch
Building a software or tech product, already DPIIT-recognised	SAMRIDH	It's investment and mentoring, not a loan
A carpenter, potter, tailor, goldsmith, barber or in another family trade	PM Vishwakarma	Cheapest loan of the five, plus training and tools

THE THING I WISH SOMEONE TOLD ME FIRST

You don't need an agent for any of these.

Every scheme here has a free government portal, and Mudra says it plainly on its website: there are no agents or middlemen for Mudra loans. If someone asks for a "file charge" to get you a scheme loan, go to the bank directly instead.

GOOD TO KNOW

"Government scheme" doesn't mean the government lends you the money.

For Mudra, Stand-Up India and PMEGP, your bank gives the loan and checks your plan. The scheme makes it easier: no collateral, a guarantee to the bank, or a subsidy. So a clean project report and a decent bank history still matter a lot.

PM Mudra Yojana, a business loan *without collateral*

Pradhan Mantri MUDRA Yojana (PMMY). MUDRA stands for Micro Units Development and Refinance Agency. Launched on 8 April 2015, and the most used business scheme in the country by a long way.

CATEGORY	LOAN AMOUNT	WHO IT SUITS
Shishu	up to ₹50,000	Just starting out. A tiffin service, a small shop, a tailoring machine
Kishore	₹50,000 to ₹5 lakh	Already running, needs stock, equipment or a second outlet
Tarun	₹5 lakh to ₹10 lakh	An established small business ready to scale
Tarun Plus	₹10 lakh to ₹20 lakh	Only for those who took a Tarun loan earlier and repaid it fully

Tarun Plus came into effect on 24 October 2024 (announced in Union Budget 2024-25). Source: Department of Financial Services, PIB.

THE DETAILS

Who can apply: Any Indian citizen with a business plan for a non-farm income activity. Manufacturing, trading, services, and activities allied to agriculture like dairy, poultry or beekeeping. Individuals, proprietorships and partnerships are fine. Not for companies.

Collateral: None. Loans are guaranteed to the bank under the Credit Guarantee Fund for Micro Units (CGFMU).

Interest: Set by your bank, linked to its normal lending rate. Compare two or three banks before you sign.

Form: Term loan for equipment, or working capital. Working capital can come as a **Mudra Card**, a RuPay debit card you draw from as needed.

Who lends: Public and private banks, regional rural banks, small finance banks, NBFCs and microfinance institutions. MUDRA itself doesn't lend directly.

HOW TO APPLY

1. Get your **Udyam registration** done on udyamregistration.gov.in. It's free and takes ten minutes with Aadhaar.
2. Write a one or two page plan: what you sell, what the money buys, how much you expect to earn each month.
3. Apply online on jansamarth.in or udyamimitra.in, or walk into your bank branch and ask for the Mudra form for your category.
4. Keep ready: Aadhaar, PAN, address proof, 6 to 12 months of bank statements, quotations for machines you'll buy.
5. The bank checks your plan and credit history, then sanctions.

THE NUMBERS THAT CONVINCED ME

57.79 crore Mudra loans worth ₹40 lakh crore since 2015. Three out of four are Shishu loans.

That tells you something useful. Mudra is built for the small first loan. If you've never taken a business loan, a Shishu or Kishore loan repaid on time is the cleanest way to build the record that unlocks bigger ones later, including Tarun Plus. About two-thirds of Mudra loans have gone to women entrepreneurs.

GOOD TO KNOW

Collateral-free still means the bank checks you.

Your CIBIL score and bank statements carry weight. If your score is low, start with a smaller Shishu amount and build up. A personal loan that's overdue somewhere else is the first thing to clear before you apply.

Stand-Up India, for women, SC and ST *first-time founders*

Launched in April 2016 to help at least one SC or ST borrower and at least one woman borrower in every bank branch start a new business. It's the bigger-ticket scheme of the five.

WHERE IT STANDS RIGHT NOW

The original window ran till 31 March 2025. A revamped version is being prepared.

On 16 March 2026, Finance Minister Nirmala Sitharaman told the Lok Sabha that the scheme is being redrafted, after review by NITI Aayog, to give beneficiaries more benefits. Union Budget 2025 had also announced term loans of up to ₹2 crore for 5 lakh first-time women, SC and ST entrepreneurs. As of early October 2026 I couldn't find a launch notification yet. Everything below is how the scheme has worked so far, so you can get your paperwork ready now.

FEATURE	HOW IT WORKED
Loan size	Composite loan (term loan plus working capital) of ₹10 lakh to ₹1 crore from scheduled commercial banks
Who	SC, ST or women entrepreneurs aged 18+. For a company or firm, at least 51% of the shares and control must be with an SC, ST or woman entrepreneur
What for	Greenfield projects only, meaning a brand new business, in manufacturing, services, trading or agri-allied activities
Your share	At least 10% of project cost from you. The scheme allowed up to 25% margin money support when combined with eligible central or state schemes
Repayment	Up to 7 years, with a moratorium of up to 18 months before repayments begin
Security	Collateral or a guarantee under the Credit Guarantee Scheme for Stand-Up India (CGSSI), as decided by the bank
Where	standupmitra.in (with handholding support) or jansamarth.in

Source: Department of Financial Services scheme page. Coverage as of 28 February 2025: 2.67 lakh accounts, ₹60,504 crore sanctioned, 1.99 lakh women beneficiaries.

WHAT YOU CAN DO TODAY

1. Register your idea on **standupmitra.in**. It has free handholding agencies for project reports and training.
2. Get your Udyam registration and a proper project report (DPR) done.
3. If your project is under ₹10 lakh, look at Mudra or PMEGP right now instead of waiting.
4. Follow PIB and the DFS website for the relaunch notification.

WHY I STILL INCLUDED IT

It shows up in every viral scheme list, and plenty of posts still say "apply now". I'd rather you know the real status before you visit a bank.

The good news is the government has said in Parliament the new version will give *more*, not less. If you fit the profile, a ready project report puts you at the front of the line when it opens.

PMEGP, where part of the loan *is paid for you*

Prime Minister's Employment Generation Programme. Run by the Ministry of MSME through KVIC (Khadi and Village Industries Commission), state KVIBs and District Industries Centres. Of all five, this one has the most direct cash benefit.

1 The subsidy you don't repay

WHO YOU ARE	YOUR CONTRIBUTION	SUBSIDY, URBAN	SUBSIDY, RURAL
General category	10%	15%	25%
Special category: SC, ST, OBC, minorities, women, ex-servicemen, transgender, persons with disability, North East, hill and border areas, aspirational districts	5%	25%	35%

Subsidy is a percentage of the project cost. The bank lends the rest. Source: PMEGP guidelines, Ministry of MSME (PIB, 2022 revision).

TYPE OF UNIT	MAX PROJECT COST	EDUCATION NEEDED
Manufacturing	₹50 lakh	8th pass if the project is above ₹10 lakh
Service or business	₹20 lakh	8th pass if the project is above ₹5 lakh

Land cost is not counted in the project cost. Projects without any capital expenditure aren't eligible.

2 What it looks like on a ₹10 lakh unit

This took me a while to get straight, so here it is with real numbers. Say you're setting up a small food processing unit costing ₹10 lakh.

	WOMAN, RURAL AREA	GENERAL, URBAN AREA
You put in	₹50,000	₹1,00,000
Bank loan	₹9,50,000	₹9,00,000
Subsidy (kept in a 3-year deposit)	₹3,50,000	₹1,50,000
Loan you actually repay	₹6,00,000	₹7,50,000

Illustrative. Under PMEGP rules, no interest is charged on the subsidy portion while it sits in the deposit.

THE BIT THAT CHANGED MY MIND

The subsidy isn't cash in your hand on day one. It's a cushion that knocks off your loan after 3 years.

The bank keeps the subsidy as a Term Deposit Receipt (TDR) in your name. If your unit is running after three years and passes the physical verification, it gets adjusted against your loan. So the whole design rewards one thing: keep the unit running.

PMEGP rules and *how to apply*

The scheme has been running since 2008. In its latest round of disbursements (September 2026), KVIC released ₹289 crore of subsidy for 3,366 new units.

WHO CAN APPLY

Age: 18 years or above. No income limit.

New units only. An existing business, or one that already got a government subsidy under another scheme, can't use PMEGP for a first loan.

One per family. Family here means you and your spouse.

Also eligible: self-help groups, charitable trusts, societies registered under the Societies Act, and production cooperatives.

Not covered: a negative list that includes meat, intoxicants like alcohol and tobacco, and direct crop cultivation. Agro-processing is allowed.

Collateral: RBI rules say banks can't take collateral on micro and small enterprise loans up to ₹20 lakh, and PMEGP units are named specifically. This limit went up from ₹10 lakh for loans sanctioned or renewed from 1 April 2026. Above that, banks can use CGTMSE, the government credit guarantee.

HOW TO APPLY

1. Go to the **PMEGP e-portal** on kviconline.gov.in and fill the online application. No fee.
2. Upload Aadhaar, PAN, a photo, education certificate if needed, caste or special-category certificate if claiming higher subsidy, and the project report.
3. Choose your agency (KVIC, KVIB or DIC) and your bank. The agency checks it and forwards it to the bank.
4. Bank appraises and sanctions the loan. Your own contribution goes in first.
5. Finish the **EDP training** (Entrepreneurship Development Programme). It's mandatory and free, and the bank needs your completion certificate.
6. Bank claims the subsidy and parks it as your 3-year TDR.

ALREADY RUNNING A PMEGP UNIT?

There's a second loan for upgrading. Up to ₹1 crore for manufacturing, ₹25 lakh for services.

If your first unit has done well and repaid on time, you can get a second loan to expand, with a 15% subsidy (20% in the North East and hill states). Ask your bank or the DIC about the "second loan for upgradation".

GOOD TO KNOW

The project report decides most of this.

A clear project report is what moves a PMEGP file fastest. Banks look for realistic sales numbers, quotations for the machines, and a plan for where you'll sell. The KVIC portal has sample project profiles for hundreds of businesses. Start from one of those and fill in your own numbers. If you're not sure, the DIC in your district will help you for free.

A SHORTCUT I USE NOW

Ask the District Industries Centre first, the bank second.

The DIC knows which local branches are processing PMEGP files quickly. One visit there saves a lot of back and forth.

SAMRIDH, for people building *tech products*

Startup Accelerators of MeitY for pRодукt Innovation, Development and growth. Run by the MeitY Startup Hub under the Ministry of Electronics and IT. Launched in August 2021.

This one is different from the other four, and it confused me at first. It isn't a loan, and you don't apply to a bank. SAMRIDH works through **accelerators**, which are programmes (often run by IITs, IIMs, incubators and private firms) that take in a small batch of startups and help them grow over a few months. MeitY picks the accelerators. The accelerators pick the startups.

FEATURE	WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU
Funding	Up to ₹40 lakh per startup from MeitY, based on your current valuation and growth stage
Matching	The accelerator or an investor puts in an equal matching investment alongside it
Accelerator support	MeitY gives the accelerator ₹2 lakh per startup to run the programme
What else you get	Mentoring, customer connections, investor introductions and help going international
Cohort size	Small batches of about 5 to 10 startups per accelerator
Sectors	IT and software product startups: healthtech, edtech, agritech, fintech, SaaS, consumer tech, sustainability

Sources: MeitY reply in Parliament and coverage dated 5 February 2026; Vikaspedia (Government of India) scheme page.

WHO CAN APPLY

DPIIT-recognised startup. Get recognised on startupindia.gov.in first. It's free.

Tech product focus. A software or digital product with a scalable model. A services agency or a regular shop doesn't fit here.

Early stage, but real. Accelerators usually look for a working product, a few customers or pilots, and a committed founding team.

HOW TO GET IN

1. Get DPIIT recognition on startupindia.gov.in.
2. Check the SAMRIDH page on msh.meity.gov.in for the list of selected accelerators.
3. Watch those accelerators for their next cohort call and apply with your pitch deck.
4. Once selected, the funding comes as you hit the milestones agreed with the accelerator.

HOW IT'S GOING SO FAR

373 startups accelerated, 241 got matching funding, ₹93.75 crore released.

That's over five years, through 43 accelerators across 16 states (as reported in February 2026). It's a selective programme. Treat it like applying to a good college: one strong application to the right accelerator beats ten rushed ones.

GOOD TO KNOW

Matching investment usually means the investor gets equity.

Read the term sheet from your accelerator carefully, or have someone who has raised money before read it with you. Know what share of your company you're giving and on what valuation.

PM Vishwakarma, for the people who *work with their hands*

Launched on 17 September 2023 with an outlay of ₹13,000 crore. Run by the Ministry of MSME. Meant for family-based traditional trades, the carpenter down your street, the tailor, the potter, the barber.

BENEFIT	AMOUNT	DETAILS
Recognition	Free	PM Vishwakarma certificate and ID card
Skill training	₹500/day	Basic training of 5 to 7 days, advanced training of 15 days or more. You're paid a stipend while you learn
Toolkit	₹15,000	E-voucher for modern tools, given at the start of basic training. Toolkits are delivered home by India Post
Loan, 1st part	₹1 lakh	Collateral-free, 18 months to repay, 5% interest . The government covers up to 8% interest subvention to the bank
Loan, 2nd part	₹2 lakh	30 months to repay. Once the first part is fully repaid and you've either started digital payments in your business or finished advanced training. Not earlier than 6 months after the first loan
Digital payments	₹1 per txn	For up to 100 digital transactions a month
Marketing	Support	Quality certification, branding, trade fairs, onboarding to GeM, ONDC and e-commerce sites

Source: Ministry of MSME, PIB backgrounder; progress figures as of 16 September 2026.

THE 18 TRADES

Carpenter · Boat maker · Armourer · Blacksmith · Hammer and tool kit maker · Locksmith · Goldsmith · Potter · Sculptor, stone carver and stone breaker · Cobbler and footwear artisan · Mason · Basket, mat, broom maker and coir weaver · Traditional doll and toy maker · Barber · Garland maker · Washerman · Tailor · Fishing net maker

WHO CAN APPLY AND HOW

Eligible: 18+, self-employed in one of the 18 trades, working with hands and tools. One person per family (husband, wife, unmarried children). Nobody in government service, and no one whose family member is.

Earlier loans: The scheme is for those who haven't taken a similar government self-employment loan, like PMEGP, in the last 5 years. Mudra and PM SVANidhi borrowers are eligible once that loan is fully repaid.

Apply: At a Common Service Centre (CSC) with Aadhaar, mobile number and bank details. Registration is free with biometric verification. It's then checked at gram panchayat or urban local body level, the district, and the state.

THREE YEARS IN

30 lakh artisans registered, 24 lakh trained, 18 lakh toolkits delivered, 6.19 lakh loans worth ₹5,316 crore.

If someone in your family runs one of these trades, this is the cheapest business loan in this guide by far. 5% is lower than most home loans.

GOOD TO KNOW

The 30 lakh registration target was reached in September 2026.

Before you go, check at your nearest CSC or on pmvishwakarma.gov.in whether new registrations are open in your area. If you're already registered, book your basic training. The toolkit voucher comes at the start of it, and the loan comes after you complete it.

Before you walk into *any bank*

Most of these steps are common to all five schemes. Do them once and you're ready for whichever one fits.

1 The paperwork, in order

- ☐ **Aadhaar linked to your mobile number.** Every portal here uses OTP or biometric login.
- ☐ **PAN card**, and the business bank account in the same name.
- ☐ **Udyam registration** on udyamregistration.gov.in. Free, Aadhaar-based, no documents to upload. It's the MSME identity banks ask for.
- ☐ **Check your CIBIL score** once (free on the CIBIL website). Clear any small overdue EMI or credit card dues first.
- ☐ **Project report.** What you'll make or sell, what it costs, quotations for machines, expected monthly sales, and how you'll repay. One to five pages is fine for Mudra; PMEGP and Stand-Up India need a fuller one.
- ☐ **6 to 12 months of bank statements**, and ITR if you file one.
- ☐ **Category certificate** (SC, ST, OBC, disability, ex-servicemen) if you're claiming a special-category benefit.
- ☐ **Address proof for the business:** rent agreement, property tax receipt or electricity bill.
- ☐ For SAMRIDH: **DPIIT recognition** on startupindia.gov.in and a pitch deck instead of a loan file.

2 Where to apply, all in one table

SCHEME	OFFICIAL PORTAL	OFFLINE OPTION
Mudra	jansamarth.in · udyamimitra.in · mudra.org.in	Any bank branch, RRB, NBFC or MFI
Stand-Up India	standupmitra.in · jansamarth.in	Bank branch, once the relaunch opens
PMEGP	kviconline.gov.in (PMEGP e-portal)	District Industries Centre, KVIC or KVIB office
SAMRIDH	msh.meity.gov.in · startupindia.gov.in	Directly with a SAMRIDH accelerator
PM Vishwakarma	pmvishwakarma.gov.in	Common Service Centre (CSC)

WHAT FINALLY SETTLED IT FOR ME

Can you combine them? Sometimes, and it's worth asking.

A repaid Mudra loan doesn't stop you from PM Vishwakarma later. A state-level subsidy can sometimes sit on top of a central one, and Stand-Up India was designed to converge with other schemes. What you usually can't do is take two central subsidies for the same project. Your DIC officer can tell you what applies in your state.

GOOD TO KNOW

Every scheme has a free grievance route.

If your application sits with no reply, use the bank's grievance cell, then the RBI Integrated Ombudsman at cms.rbi.org.in for loan issues, or CPGRAMS (pgportal.gov.in) for the scheme side. A polite, written follow-up moves files.

Every term in this guide, *decoded*

I didn't know most of these a few years ago. Each one has a line you can use if someone asks in the comments.

Collateral

Something you pledge, like land, gold or a house, that the bank can take if you don't repay.

Loan ku security-a edhavadhu property vekkradhu.

Subsidy / margin money

Money the government pays towards your project. Under PMEGP, it reduces your loan and you don't repay it.

Government kudukra panam, thirupi kattave vendam.

Greenfield project

A completely new business, not an existing one being expanded.

Pudhusa aarambikra business, already odra business illa.

Moratorium

A starting period when you don't have to pay EMIs yet.

Konja maasam EMI kattama business settle aaga time.

Tranche

A part of a loan released in stages. Vishwakarma gives ₹1 lakh first, then ₹2 lakh.

Loan-a rendu step-a kudukradhu.

DPIIT recognition

Official startup status from the Department for Promotion of Industry and Internal Trade.

Government "idhu startup" nu certify panradhu.

Equity

A share of ownership in your company, given to an investor for their money.

Panam kudukravangaluku company la oru pangu.

NBFC / MFI / RRB

Non-bank finance companies, microfinance institutions and regional rural banks. All can give Mudra loans.

Bank illama loan kudukra financial companies.

Collateral-free

No pledge needed. A government fund guarantees the bank instead.

Edhuvum adagu vekka vendam, guarantee government kudukudhu.

Own contribution

The part of the project cost you bring from your pocket.

Project la unga share, unga kaila irundhu.

Term loan

A loan for buying assets like machines, repaid in EMIs over a few years.

Machine vaanga loan, EMI la thirupi kattuvom.

TDR (Term Deposit Receipt)

A fixed deposit. PMEGP subsidy sits in one for 3 years before it adjusts your loan.

Subsidy 3 varusham FD la irukkum.

Udyam registration

Free government registration that officially makes you an MSME.

Unga business ku government ID card maadhiri.

Accelerator

A short programme that funds, mentors and connects a small batch of startups.

Startup-a vegama valaka help panra program.

EDP

Entrepreneurship Development Programme. Free basic business training, mandatory for PMEGP.

Business eppadi nadathanum nu oru chinna training.

CSC

Common Service Centre. Local digital help centres for government services.

Ooru la irukra e-seva maadhiri centre.

Credit guarantee (CGFMU, CGTMSE, CGSSI)

Government-backed funds that repay the bank a large part of the loss if a borrower defaults.

Neenga kattalana, bank ku loss-a indha fund cover pannum.

Project cost

Everything needed to start: machines, setup, initial working capital. Land is not counted under PMEGP.

Business start panna motham evlo selavu aagum.

Working capital

Money for day-to-day running: stock, raw material, salaries.

Daily business odradhuku thevaiyana panam.

Interest subvention

The government pays part of your interest to the bank, so your rate is lower.

Vatti la oru part government kattudhu.

MSME

Micro, Small and Medium Enterprises. The category most small businesses fall into.

Chinna, nadutharam business ellam indha group.

Matching investment

For every rupee the government puts in, an investor puts in an equal amount.

Government evlo podudho, adhe alavu investor um podanum.

DIC / KVIC / KVIB

District Industries Centre, Khadi and Village Industries Commission and its state Boards. They run PMEGP.

PMEGP file paakra government office-gal.

CIBIL score

A 300 to 900 score showing how well you've repaid past loans. Banks check it first.

Neenga loan ozhunga kattiningala nu oru mark.

Sources, dates and *the fine print*

Everything here was checked against government sources or reports of official statements between 5 and 7 October 2026. Schemes change, so check the portal before acting on anything.

1. **PM Mudra Yojana: categories, Tarun Plus, eligibility, lenders.** mudra.org.in; Department of Financial Services / PIB note on Tarun Plus (effective 24 October 2024, Union Budget 2024-25). PIB release on 11 years of PMMY (April 2026), figures as of 27 March 2026: 57.79 crore loans, ₹40.07 lakh crore sanctioned, about two-thirds to women, Shishu 74% of loans by count.
2. **Stand-Up India: terms and coverage.** Department of Financial Services scheme page (financialservices.gov.in), standupmitra.in. Coverage figures as of 28 February 2025. Scheme valid up to 31 March 2025.
3. **Stand-Up India relaunch.** Finance Minister's statement in the Lok Sabha, 16 March 2026 (All India Radio News, Telangana Today). Union Budget 2025-26 announcement of term loans up to ₹2 crore for 5 lakh first-time women, SC and ST entrepreneurs.
4. **PMEGP: subsidy rates, project cost limits.** PIB release on continuation of PMEGP for 2021-22 to 2025-26 with revised limits; PMEGP guidelines on kviconline.gov.in; Bank of Maharashtra PMEGP page for eligibility and terms.
5. **PMEGP: recent disbursements.** KVIC, Seva Sankalp Khadi Mahotsav, 18 September 2026 (₹289 crore, 3,366 units); Khadi Rozgar Utsav, 18 June 2026 (₹504.68 crore, 22,259 units).
6. **SAMRIDH.** MeitY reply in Parliament reported 5 February 2026 (373 startups, 241 funded, ₹93.75 crore, 43 accelerators in 16 states); Vikaspedia scheme page (up to ₹40 lakh, equal matching investment, launched August 2021); Lok Sabha answer on first cohort (22 accelerators, 175 startups).
7. **PM Vishwakarma.** Ministry of MSME / PIB backgrounder (18 trades, benefits, ₹13,000 crore, FY 2023-24 to 2027-28); Indian Bank PM Vishwakarma scheme page (eligibility, prior-loan rule, second tranche conditions); three-year progress figures reported 16 September 2026 (30 lakh registrations, 24.37 lakh trained, 18.16 lakh toolkits, 6.19 lakh loans worth ₹5,316 crore).
8. **Collateral-free MSE loans up to ₹20 lakh.** RBI, Lending to MSME Sector (Amendment) Directions, 2026, announced 9 February 2026, for loans sanctioned or renewed on or after 1 April 2026.

DISCLAIMER

I'm not a SEBI-registered investment adviser, a banker or a chartered accountant, and this is not financial or legal advice. I make finance content and I check my numbers, but scheme rules, limits and timelines are revised by the government from time to time. Everything here is general information about government schemes, dated October 2026. Final eligibility, interest rates and approval are decided by the bank and the implementing agency. Always confirm on the official portal or with your bank before you apply. Nobody needs to pay an agent to apply for any of these schemes.

Free to share. Send it to *someone who's been planning a business for years.*

That cousin with the bakery idea. The friend whose dad runs a carpentry shop. If one of them applies because of this, the whole thing was worth writing.

@buildwithabinash